

Treat foundation models as a portfolio, not a bet

Frontier tier: off by default

switched on only when an evaluation shows the mid tier fails a named use case

	PINNED VERSION	REGION	QUALIFIED ON EVAL SUITE	RETIREMENT RUNWAY
Primary drafting mid tier · vendor A	exact dated version, never "latest"	UK / EU, in tenant	✓ this quarter	≥ 6 months
Fallback drafting mid tier · different vendor	exact dated version	same region and data terms	✓ same suite, last quarter	tracked
Small classifier high volume, cheap	exact dated version	in region	✓ this quarter	tracked
Self-hosted open weight, firm's estate	hash-pinned weights	firm's own estate	✓ this quarter	firm controls it



One gateway routes every call

version pins · fallback · budgets · logging

THE SIGNAL

Qualified-alternative coverage

share of use cases with a second-vendor model that passed the same evaluation last quarter. Target for an important business service: **100%**

AT EVERY TIER

No model produces authoritative figures

numbers come from the system of record